

Dewald Laubscher

Software Engineering Leader | Senior Software Engineer | Platform Modernization

Atlanta, GA / Open to California or Remote | laubscher.dewald@gmail.com

LinkedIn: [linkedin.com/in/dewaldlaubscher](https://www.linkedin.com/in/dewaldlaubscher) | Portfolio/GitHub: <https://github.com/dewwwald>

Professional Summary

Software engineering leader with 12+ years of experience across startups, acquisitions, and enterprise environments, including Senior Software Engineer experience at Intuit Mailchimp and founding engineering leadership at BigTeam. Experienced leading a small engineering teams of 3-4 people, hiring and managing contractors, mentoring engineers, modernizing platform systems, and delivering scalable data infrastructure. Strong blend of hands-on technical depth, technical tradeoff management, and people leadership, with a focus on developer productivity, pragmatic architecture, and business impact.

Leadership & Platform Highlights

- Founding Engineering Lead experience guiding a small team of up to 5 people with pragmatic hands-on mentorship, delivery planning, contractor coordination, onboarding, and architectural decisions.
 - Built and prototyped AI-assisted workflows across orchestration, multi-agent systems, thematic analysis, and developer productivity.
 - Intuit Mailchimp platform experience across large-scale data processing, legacy modernization, and enterprise-scale engineering complexity.
 - Technical depth across Kafka, Redshift, Debezium, microservices,DDD, dependency injection, modular architecture, and Strangler Fig migrations.
 - Improved microservice data migration by reducing processed-ID checks from $O(n)$ to $O(1)$ enabling idempotent processing.
 - Motivated to build platforms that support Intuit's mission to power prosperity on a global scale.
-

Experience

Intuit Mailchimp

Senior Software Engineer | Aug 2022 – Present

Mississauga, Ontario & Atlanta, GA

- Built custom AI orchestration workflows and collaborated on multi-agent prototypes to improve developer productivity, planning, and workflow automation.
- Contributed to platform infrastructure and legacy modernization across large-scale data systems using Kafka, Redshift, Debezium, microservices, and Strangler Fig migration patterns.
- Improved microservice migration backfill performance by reducing processed-ID checks from $O(n)$ to $O(1)$ with a hashing-based lookup strategy.
- Partnered across engineering, product, and platform stakeholders to align modernization work with roadmap priorities, navigate legacy constraints, and drive pragmatic architectural tradeoffs.
- Mentored 7 engineers through complex technical work, emphasizing autonomy, clarity, maintainability, and strong engineering judgment.

Software Engineer (Mailchimp Contractor) | Jun 2020 – Aug 2022

Johannesburg & Cape Town, South Africa

- Built and maintained full-stack software systems in a product engineering environment during Mailchimp's growth and acquisition by Intuit.
 - Contributed to scalable, maintainable application architecture while adapting to increasing organizational and technical complexity.
 - Aligned stakeholders by collaborating across engineering and product teams to deliver reliable software features.
 - Developed stronger engineering judgment around pragmatic patterns, roadmap alignment, and building systems that serve business outcomes.
-

BigTeam LLC

Founding Engineering Lead | Oct 2019 – Jun 2020

Johannesburg, South Africa

- Led a team of 3 engineers through delivery planning, technical direction, code review, contractor coordination, onboarding, and product execution during BigTeam's growth toward acquisition by Mailchimp.
- Helped transition the engineering function from early contractor-led delivery toward a more stable full-time engineering team, establishing lightweight practices for planning, technical standards, autonomy, and delivery accountability.
- Coached engineers through architecture decisions, implementation tradeoffs, and delivery expectations while maintaining a leadership style grounded in trust, clarity, empathy, and accountability.
- Translated ambiguous product and business needs into executable engineering plans, balancing speed, maintainability, scalability, and business impact.

Founding Engineer | Aug 2017 – Oct 2019

Johannesburg, South Africa

- Built core product systems and full-stack capabilities across front-end, back-end, and product workflows in a fast-moving startup environment.
 - Designed custom AI-assisted thematic analysis workflows and algorithms combining sentiment scoring, classification logic, and expert-system rules to identify themes across survey responses.
 - Grew into engineering leadership through delivery ownership, architectural guidance, mentoring, and consistent execution on high-priority product work.
-

Earlier Experience

Developer | Jan 2014 – Sep 2019

- Delivered 80+ websites and full-stack web projects across agency, product, and client environments, building strong foundations in front-end, back-end, deployment, client communication, and production support.
 - Bachelors in Computer Science and Information Technology, from NWU, Potchefstroom, South Africa (2011 - 2013)
-

Technical Skills

Leadership: Engineering mentorship, technical direction, roadmap execution, team autonomy, stakeholder collaboration, architecture design, delivery planning, people-centered engineering leader.

Platform & Architecture: Platform modernization, scalable architecture, legacy migration, microservices, Strangler Fig pattern, modular systems, domain-driven design, dependency injection, AI native platforms, AI Orchestration Workflows

Data & Infrastructure: Kafka, Redshift, Debezium, custom backfills, large-scale data processing, data pipelines, petabyte-scale SMS and Mailchimp audience data

Engineering: Full-stack, distributed systems, API design, system design, production readiness, multi-agent, workflow automation

Languages & Frameworks: PHP, JavaScript/TypeScript, Java, Bash, Python, Kotlin, React, Angular, Node, Laravel, Spring.

Cloud & Tools: AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Splunk, PagerDuty.